Figure 12.5: MongoDB Compass with new user connection.

Now we have a MongoDB database and collection set up, along with a user that has read/write access to the `productdb` database. You can use this connection string in your Laravel application to interact with MongoDB.

You can now connect to MongoDB using the new user credentials:

```
mongodb://appuser:pass12345@localhost:27017/productdb
```

12.10.4.2 Step 2: Install MongoDB Driver for Laravel

To work with MongoDB in Laravel, we should install MongoDB driver for Laravel.

Linux, Unix, and macOS users may run the following command to install the extension:

```
sudo pecl install mongodb
```

Finally, add the following line to the php.ini file for each environment that will need to use the extension:

```
extension=mongodb.so
```

For macOS users, you can use Homebrew to install the MongoDB extension:

```
brew tap shivammathur/php
brew install shivammathur/extensions/mongodb@8.4
```

For Windows users, you can download the appropriate DLL file from the PECL repository, https://pecl.php.net/package/mongodb and place it in your PHP extensions directory.

For instance, we use mongodb pecl version 2.0.0 for PHP 8.4. You can download the DLL file from the following link:

https://pecl.php.net/package/mongodb/2.0.0/windows

Download DLL based on your PHP version and architecture (x86 or x64). Place the downloaded DLL file in your PHP extensions directory, usually located at `C:\xampp\php\ext` or `C:\php\phpX.X.X\ext`.